

YOGURT-MARINATED CHICKEN SKEWERS WITH LEMON BROWN BUTTER RICE PILAF

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Lemon Brown Butter Rice Pilaf (makes about 3 cups)

4 Tbsp (28 g) Salted Butter
½ cup (100 g) Orzo Pasta
1 cup (195 g) Long Grain Rice, rinsed and strained
2 cups (450 g) Water
½ tsp Kosher Salt
1 tsp (4 g) Chicken Bouillon
Peel of 1 Lemon*
1 Tbsp Lemon Juice or ¼ of a Lemon juiced

*To peel a lemon, use a vegetable peeler.

Chicken Skewers

1 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breast, diced
into 1 to 1 ½" pieces
1 batch of Spiced Yogurt Marinade
2 (8-inch) Wooden or Metal Skewers

Accompaniments

2 handfuls finely shredded Cabbage
¼ cup Radish Batons
¼ cup or remaining crumbled Feta
1 Tbsp chopped Mint
1 Tbsp chopped Parsley
1 Tbsp chopped Dill
Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*
Tahini Date Dressing, *to taste*
1 ½ cups (or ½ batch) cooked Lemon Brown Butter Rice
Pilaf, reheated
2 Tbsp Herbed Yogurt
2 Tbsp Crazy Feta



- recipes that can be prepped ahead of time

Instructions

Prepare Lemon Brown Butter Rice Pilaf

1. Melt **butter** in a saucepan (fitted with a lid) over medium-high heat. Once the butter is fully melted, turn the heat down to low and cook for an additional 3-4 minutes, occasionally stirring, until the butter gradually begins to foam.
2. Once brown bits form on the bottom of the pan, add **orzo** and stir. Cook until the orzo is golden brown and toasted, *about 2-3 minutes*.
3. Stir in **rice** and toast for an additional 1 minute. Add **water, salt, chicken bouillon**, and **lemon peel**, and bring to a boil over high heat.
4. Once the water comes to a rolling boil, stir once, reduce the heat to low/simmer, cover with a lid, and cook for 17-18 minutes.
5. Remove the rice pilaf from heat and let it rest, covered, for 10 minutes.
6. After 10 minutes, remove the lid, and lemon peel, and add **lemon juice**. Stir until combined.

To Store: Transfer the rice pilaf to an airtight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use—it will be utilized in 2 recipes this week.

Prepare the Chicken Skewers & Plate

1. Pat **chicken breast** dry with a paper towel and transfer it to a medium bowl. Cover the chicken with the **spiced yogurt marinade** and marinate it at room temperature for at least 30 minutes (or in the refrigerator for up to 8 hours).
2. Preheat your oven* to 400°F.
3. Assemble the marinated chicken on skewers (*about 8-9 pieces per skewer*).
4. Place the chicken skewers on a baking sheet topped with a wire rack and bake for 15-17 minutes, flipping halfway.
5. Switch your oven temperature/setting to broil and finish cooking the chicken skewers for 1-2 minutes until slightly charred and the internal temperature reaches 165°F.
6. Transfer the chicken skewers to a plate and allow them to rest for 5 minutes before serving.
7. In a small mixing bowl, combine **cabbage, radish, feta, mint, parsley, dill, tahini date dressing** and **pepper**. Stir until well combined.
8. Serve **rice pilaf** and side salad with chicken skewers, **herbed yogurt**, and **crazy feta**.

*see Substack note in 'A Few Quick Notes' for alternative options



SPICED FETA MEATBALL & ORZO SOUP WITH LEMON CHIMICHURRI

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Spiced Feta Meatballs



(makes 12-13 meatballs)

1 lb Ground Chicken
½ cup crumbled Feta
1 Tbsp Olive Oil
2 ½ tsp Ground Cumin
2 tsp Kosher Salt
1 tsp Dried Oregano
1 tsp Onion Powder
1 tsp Ground Turmeric
½ tsp Garlic Powder
Cayenne Pepper, *to taste*
Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*
1 clove of Garlic, grated
Zest of 1 Lemon
Juice of ½ a Lemon
Neutral Oil (*for cooking*)

Spiced Feta Meatball & Orzo Soup

Olive Oil
½ Yellow Onion, ¼" diced (about ½ cup)
2 cloves of Garlic, grated
¾ cup Orzo Pasta
Zest of ½ Lemon
2 cups Chicken Stock
2 cups Water
¾ tsp Chicken Bouillon
¼ tsp Kosher Salt, *plus more to taste*
Juice of ½ Lemon
1 Egg
¼ cup chopped Dill
2 Tbsp chopped Parsley
6-7 Spiced Feta Meatballs
Lemon Chimichurri, *to taste*
Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Instructions

Prepare the Spiced Feta Meatballs



1. Place **all ingredients** in a large mixing bowl and stir until everything is well combined.

Hot Tip: The more you stir/work your ground meat, the more bouncy your meatballs will be. The less you stir, the more crumbly they will be (i.e., mix to your liking).

2. Preheat your oven to 400°F.
3. Heat a thin layer of **neutral oil** in a large skillet over medium-high heat.
4. Using a large spoon or cookie scooper, scoop out 1 ½- to 2-inch rounds of meat and drop the meatballs directly into the hot oil. Cook each side until golden brown—*around 2-3 minutes per side*.
5. Transfer the meatballs to a baking sheet and finish cooking until the internal temperature reaches 165°F (*the time will vary based on the size of your meatballs*)

To Store: Allow the meatballs to come to room temperature, transfer them to an airtight container, and store them in the refrigerator for later use—they will be utilized in 2 recipes this week.

Prepare the Spiced Feta Meatball Soup

1. Heat a few glugs of **olive oil** in a large saucepan over medium-high heat. Once hot, add **onion** and a pinch of **salt** and sauté until soft and translucent (around 3-4 minutes).
2. Add **garlic**, **orzo**, and **lemon zest** and sauté for an additional 2-3 minutes. Once the orzo is slightly toasted and golden brown, stir in the **chicken stock**, **water**, **chicken bouillon**, and ¼ tsp salt. Reduce the heat to medium-low and cook for 13-15 minutes.
3. In a small bowl, vigorously whisk **lemon juice** and **egg** until light and frothy. While constantly whisking, *slowly* stream in about ¼ cup of the hot broth from the soup. Whisk until foamy—*about 30 seconds*.
4. Now, while stirring the soup, pour the tempered egg mixture into the pot. Stir until slightly thickened, about 1 minute.

Hot Tip: This process is called tempering, a technique where you slowly introduce a hot liquid (like hot broth) to a cold, heat-sensitive ingredient (like eggs) to prevent curdling or scrambling. This helps ensure a smooth final dish.

5. Stir **dill**, **parsley**, and **spiced feta meatballs** into the soup and simmer for 2-3 minutes until the meatballs are fully heated through.
6. Plate and garnish soup with **lemon chimichurri** and **freshly ground black pepper**.



- recipes that can be prepped ahead of time



MEDITERRANEAN-STYLE PIZZA SANDWICHES WITH SPICED FETA MEATBALLS

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

1 batch of Pizza Dough
All-Purpose Flour, *for dusting*
½ cup Crazy Feta, separated
Olive Oil
Kosher Salt, *to taste*
6 Spiced Feta Meatballs, crumbled into bite-sized pieces
1-2 large handfuls finely shredded Cabbage
¼ cup Radish Batons
1 Tbsp chopped Mint, *plus more for garnish*
1 Tbsp chopped Dill, *plus more for garnish*
1 Tbsp chopped Parsley, *plus more for garnish*
Tahini Date Dressing, *to taste*
¼ cup Herbed Yogurt

*see note on Substack

Instructions

1. Pull **pizza dough** out, and allow 30-45 minutes for it to come to room temperature before stretching it out.
2. Preheat your oven to 480°F.
3. Divide the pizza dough into two even rounds. Stretch each dough round on a lightly **floured** surface into 7- to 8-inch wide circles (or ovals).
4. On each round of dough, evenly crumble about **2-3 tablespoons of crazy feta**, then lightly drizzle with **olive oil** and top with a light pinch of **salt**. Using your fingers or an offset spatula, gently spread the feta onto the dough.
5. Fold each round of dough in half (onto itself), forming a half-moon, and place on a parchment-lined baking sheet. Top each round with another small drizzle of olive oil and bake for 11-13 minutes or until lightly toasted.
6. Remove the pizza sandwiches from the oven and sprinkle the crumbled **spiced feta meatballs** into the center of each sandwich (*directly on top of the melted feta*).
7. Close the pizza sandwiches back up and place them in the oven to cook for an additional 2-3 minutes—*until golden brown and crispy*.
8. While the pizza sandwiches finish baking, combine **cabbage, radish, mint, dill, parsley, and tahini date dressing** in a small mixing bowl and toss until well combined.
9. Remove the pizza sandwiches from the oven and allow them to cool for 2-3 minutes. Once slightly cooled, stuff the inside of each sandwich with the tossed cabbage slaw and **herbed yogurt**. Garnish with additional chopped herbs.



CRISPY WHITE FISH WITH LEMON CHIMICHURRI

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Crispy Fish

Neutral Oil

2 (4 oz) Tilapia Fillets

½ cup Cornstarch

¼ tsp Kosher Salt, *plus more to taste*

¼ tsp Garlic Powder

1 Egg

Cabbage Slaw

Finely shredded Cabbage

¼ cup Radish Batons

1 Tbsp chopped Mint

1 Tbsp chopped Dill

1 Tbsp chopped Parsley

Tahini Date Dressing, *to taste*

Accompaniment

Lemon Chimichurri, *to taste*

1 ½ cups (or ½ batch) cooked Lemon Brown Butter Rice

Pilaf, reheated

Instructions

Prepare the Fish

1. Heat a ¼" layer of **neutral oil** in a small frying pan over medium-high heat.
2. While the oil preheats, generously season the **tilapia fillets** with **salt**. Allow the fish to rest for 5 minutes before patting dry with a paper towel.
3. In a shallow bowl, combine **cornstarch**, **salt**, and **garlic powder**.
4. In a separate shallow bowl, whisk the **egg** and season with a pinch of salt.
5. Place the tilapia fillets in the egg mixture, fully coating each one. Then, transfer the fillets to the cornstarch mixture and fully coat them.
6. Once the oil reaches about 375°F, gently place the coated tilapia fillets in the hot oil and fry for 6-8 minutes, flipping every 2 minutes.
7. When the fish is golden brown and crispy on all sides, transfer each fillet to a paper towel-lined plate and season with a small pinch of salt.

Assemble the Cabbage Slaw & Plate

1. In a small mixing bowl, combine **cabbage**, **radish**, **mint**, **dill**, **parsley**, and **tahini date vinaigrette**—stir until well combined.
2. Plate the fried tilapia on top of the cabbage slaw and garnish with a generous spoonful of **lemon chimichurri**. Serve alongside the reheated **lemon brown butter rice pilaf**.



LEMON ORZOTTO WITH SPICED SHRIMP

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Lemon Orzotto

Olive Oil
½ small Yellow Onion, finely diced (about ½ cup)
Kosher Salt
1 cup Orzo Pasta
2 cloves of Garlic, grated
2 Tbsp White Wine Vinegar
2 cups Chicken Stock
2-3 cups Water*
2 Tbsp Salted Butter
Zest of ½ a Lemon
1 Tbsp Lemon Juice or ¼ of a Lemon juiced
A large handful finely shredded Cabbage (*optional*)
Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Spiced Shrimp

16-18 Medium Shrimp, thawed, peeled, & deveined
¾ tsp Chili Powder
¼ tsp Cayenne Pepper
A generous pinch of Kosher Salt
Neutral Oil
2 Tbsp Salted Butter
1 Tbsp Lemon Juice, or ¼ of a Lemon juiced
Chopped Parsley, *for garnish*

Instructions

Prepare the Lemon Orzotto

1. Heat a few glugs of **olive oil** in a large saucepan over medium-high heat. Once the oil is hot and shimmering, add **onion** and a pinch of **salt** and sauté until soft and translucent.
2. Stir in **orzo pasta** and toast for 2-3 minutes until lightly golden. Add **grated garlic** and **white wine vinegar** and cook until the vinegar is fully absorbed.
3. Stir in **¼ cup of stock** at a time, stirring frequently, until the stock is fully absorbed. Repeat this process—*stirring in stock and cooking until fully absorbed*—until all of the stock has been used, then switch over to **water**, repeating the same process until the orzo is fully cooked—*about 15-16 minutes*.

Hot Tip: In the final 4-5 minutes of cooking your orzotto, prepare the shrimp for a well-timed plating.

4. Once the orzo is fully cooked, turn off the heat and stir in the **butter**, **lemon zest**, **lemon juice**, and **cabbage**, mixing until smooth and creamy*. Season with additional salt and **pepper** to taste, if needed, and plate.

***Hot Tip:** If your Orzotto isn't creamy enough, add 1 to 2 tablespoons of water at a time and stir, repeating this process as needed until it reaches your desired consistency.

Spiced Shrimp

1. In a small mixing bowl, combine **shrimp**, **chili powder**, **cayenne pepper**, and **salt**.
2. Heat a few glugs of **neutral oil** in a large skillet over high heat. Add seasoned shrimp and cook until seared on both sides—*about 2 minutes per side*. Add **butter** and **lemon juice** and stir until the butter is fully melted.
3. Plate directly on top of the orzotto and garnish with **chopped parsley**.



PIZZA DOUGH

Makes 1 medium-large pizza

Ingredients

¾ cup (175 g) Warm Water (100°F - 109°F)

1 ½ tsp (6 g) White Cane Sugar

1 tsp (3 g) Active Dry Yeast

1 ¾ cups (235 g) All-Purpose Flour

1 ½ tsp (3 g) Kosher Salt

1 Tbsp (15 g) Olive Oil

Instructions

1. In a stand mixer fitted with a dough hook*, combine **water**, **sugar**, and **yeast**. Allow the mixture to sit for 3-5 minutes or until the yeast appears slightly foamy on the surface (after about 3-6 minutes).
2. Add **flour**, **salt**, and **olive oil**, and knead on low speed for 10-12 minutes. The dough should appear tacky and shiny.
3. Cover with plastic wrap and let it rise in a warm place for 1-2 hours or until doubled in size.
4. Deflate and shape the pizza dough on an oiled surface. Place it in an airtight container and refrigerate for at least 24 hours (and up to 4 days).

*See Substack note in 'Mise en Place' if kneading by hand



LEMON BROWN BUTTER RICE PILAF

Makes about 3 cups

Ingredients

4 Tbsp (28 g) Salted Butter
½ cup (100 g) Orzo Pasta
1 cup (195 g) Long Grain Rice, rinsed and strained
2 cups (450 g) Water
½ tsp Kosher Salt
1 tsp (4 g) Chicken Bouillon
Peel of 1 Lemon*
1 Tbsp Lemon Juice or ¼ of a Lemon juiced

*To peel a lemon, use a vegetable peeler.

Instructions

1. Melt **butter** in a saucepan (fitted with a lid) over medium-high heat. Once the butter is fully melted, turn the heat down to low and cook for 3-4 minutes, occasionally stirring, until the butter gradually begins to foam.
2. Once brown bits form on the bottom of the pan, add **orzo** and stir. Cook until the orzo is golden brown and toasted, *about 2-3 minutes*.
3. Stir in **rice** and toast for an additional 1 minute. Add **water, salt, chicken bouillon, and lemon peel**, and bring to a boil over high heat.
4. Once the water comes to a rolling boil, stir once, reduce the heat to low/simmer, cover with a lid, and cook for 17-18 minutes.
5. Remove the rice pilaf from heat and let it rest, covered, for 10 minutes.
6. After 10 minutes, remove the lid, and lemon peel. Add **lemon juice** and stir until combined.

To Store: Transfer the rice pilaf to an airtight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use—*it will be utilized in 2 recipes this week.*



SPICED-YOGURT MARINADE

Makes roughly 1 cup

Ingredients

¾ cup (180 g) Greek Yogurt
Juice of 1 Lemon (50 g to 60 g)
2 tsp (16 g) Honey
2 cloves of Garlic (10 g), grated
1 Tbsp (10 g) Olive Oil
2 tsp (7 g) Kosher Salt
1 tsp (2 g) Paprika
1 tsp (2 g) Oregano
1 tsp (2 g) Cumin
A pinch of Ground Cinnamon

Instructions

1. Add **all ingredients** to a mixing bowl and whisk until fully combined.

To Store: Place the marinade in an air-tight container and store it in the refrigerator.



CRAZY FETA

Makes $\frac{3}{4}$ cup

Ingredients

1 small Shallot, roughly chopped

1 Jalapeño, roughly chopped

2 cloves of Garlic (skin on)

Olive Oil

Kosher Salt

$\frac{1}{2}$ of an 8 oz block of Feta (130 g)

Instructions

1. Preheat your oven to 400°F.
2. Place **shallot**, **jalapeño**, and **garlic** on a small sheet tray and lightly coat with a drizzle of **olive oil** and a pinch of **kosher salt**.
3. Bake for 15 minutes or until the garlic, shallot, and jalapeño are soft, then rest until mostly cooled down.
4. Using an immersion blender or food processor, blend together **feta**, roasted garlic (remove the peel), shallot, and jalapeños until mostly smooth (*a few chunks are okay*) and fully combined.

To Store: Transfer the crazy feta to an air-tight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use.



HERBED YOGURT

Makes about 1 cup

Ingredients

$\frac{3}{4}$ cup (150 g) Greek Yogurt
2 Tbsp (30 g) Olive Oil
1 tsp (5 g) White Wine Vinegar
1 clove of Garlic (5 g)
 $\frac{3}{4}$ tsp (3 g) Kosher Salt
1 Tbsp chopped Dill (3 g)
1 Tbsp chopped Parsley (4 g)
1 Tbsp chopped Mint (3 g)
1 Tbsp (5 g) Water

Instructions

1. Add **all ingredients** to a mixing bowl and whisk until fully combined.

To Store: Transfer the dressing to an air-tight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use.



TAHINI DATE DRESSING

Makes about $\frac{2}{3}$ cup

Ingredients

Hot Water, *for soaking*

3 Medjool Dates (70 g), pitted & soaked

$\frac{1}{3}$ cup (60 g) Olive Oil

$\frac{1}{3}$ cup (60 g) Neutral Oil

2 Tbsp + 1 tsp (36 g) Red Wine Vinegar

1 Tbsp (20 g) Tahini

$\frac{1}{2}$ tsp (2 g) Kosher Salt

1 clove of Garlic (5 g)

Instructions

1. Place **pitted dates** in enough **hot water** to cover completely and allow to soak for at least 15 minutes.
2. Place **remaining ingredients**, and strained dates in a blender and blend until fully emulsified and smooth (it will also be thick).
3. If you'd like your dressing to be a thinner, add 1 Tbsp of water (reserved from soaking the dates) to the dressing at a time until it reaches desired consistency.

To Store: Transfer the tahini date dressing to a squeeze bottle or an air-tight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use. Shake well before using.



LEMON CHIMICHURRI

Makes about 1 cup

Ingredients

½ cup (100 g) Olive Oil
1 small Shallot, finely diced
The peel of 1 Lemon*, finely minced
Juice of 1 Lemon (38 g)
5-6 cloves of Garlic (35 g), grated
1 cup chopped Parsley (25 g)
3 Tbsp (30 g) Red Wine Vinegar
1 Jalapeño (20 g), finely diced
1 ½ tsp (3 g) Red Chili Flakes
1 tsp (3 g) Kosher Salt
⅛ tsp (or a pinch) White Cane Sugar

*To peel a lemon, use a vegetable peeler. Once peeled, thinly slice (to help it blend more uniformly in the food processor).

Instructions

1. Add **all ingredients** to a bowl and stir until well combined

Alternatively:

1. Place **all ingredients**, whole or roughly chopped into a food processor and pulse until finely chopped and fully combined.

To Store: Transfer the chimichurri to an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.



SPICED FETA MEATBALLS

Makes 12-14 meatballs

Ingredients

1 lb Ground Chicken
½ cup crumbled Feta
1 Tbsp Olive Oil
2 ½ tsp Ground Cumin
2 tsp Kosher Salt
1 tsp Dried Oregano
1 tsp Onion Powder
1 tsp Ground Turmeric
½ tsp Garlic Powder
Cayenne Pepper, *to taste*
Ground Pepper, *to taste*
1 clove of Garlic, grated
Zest of 1 Lemon
Juice of ½ a Lemon
Neutral Oil (*for cooking*)

Instructions

1. Place **all ingredients** in a large mixing bowl and stir until everything is well combined.

Hot Tip: The more you stir/work your ground meat, the more bouncy your meatballs will be. The less you stir, the more crumbly they will be (i.e., mix to your liking).

2. Preheat your oven to 400°F.
3. Heat a thin layer of **neutral oil** in a large skillet over medium-high heat.
4. Using a large spoon or cookie scooper, scoop out 1 ½- to 2-inch rounds of meat and drop the meatballs directly into the hot oil. Cook each side until golden brown—*around 2-3 minutes per side*.
5. Transfer the meatballs to a baking sheet and finish cooking until the internal temperature reaches 165°F (the time will vary based on the size of your meatballs).

To Store: Allow the meatballs to come to room temperature, transfer them to an airtight container, and store them in the refrigerator for later use.

